A-A-979A
June 18, 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-979
May 12, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MULTI-STRIKE TYPEWRITER RIBBONS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers multi-strike typewriter ribbons.

Salient characteristics.

Ribbons shall consist of a continuous length of plastic film coated on one side with black imaging material, and have an appropriate leader, trailer, and visible warning signal.

Ribbons shall be of the dimensions established by the machine manufacturer for proper operations, and be firmly, evenly, and uniformly wound in cartridges, or on spools or cores designed for proper operation with the machines specified (see note).

Composition and application of the imaging material shall be such that it does not offset from one layer to the next.

When properly installed in accordance with the machine manufacturer's instructions the ribbon shall not tear nor be cut through during the typing operation and take up smoothly, evenly, and completely.

The ribbons shall produce black impressions which are of uniform density, clean, legible and sharp, without smears or smudges and suitable for reproduction processes.

Workmanship. The plastic film shall be free from holes, tears, or blisters; the imaging material shall be smoothly and evenly applied and of uniform thickness; and the ribbons free of defects such as pinholes, foreign material, streaks, or other imperfections which could adversely affect performance and

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

serviceability. In addition, ribbons shall be free from ragged or nicked edges, and the cartridges free from any defects which may affect serviceability.

Performance test. Select one sample ribbon and place in the machine designated for its use in the contract and operate the machine in the normal manner until the ribbon has run its full course and is wound from one side to the other. If the machine is designed for ribbon reverse, the "full course" shall include reversal and continuous operation for at least one quarter of the return length of the ribbon. During the course of the test operation, the ribbon shall be observed to ensure that it is not binding or twisting so as to interfere with proper printing. Upon completion of the test, the printed matter (the product of the ribbon printing test) shall be examined to ensure that quality of print is uniformly dark and not with blank spots, light spots, or discontinuities. Failure to comply with any of these requirements shall be cause for rejection.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified, in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein.

Sampling. Sampling for inspection and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all ribbons of the same description manufactured under the same conditions at essentially the same time.

Sampling of end item for visual examination. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall not exceed 2.5 percent defective. The sample shall be one ribbon.

Sampling of end items for tests. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-1. The AQL shall not exceed 2.5 percent defective.

Examination of end item for visual defects. Sample shall be examined for defects listed. Any ribbon containing one or more defects shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect any not listed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defects
Cartridge and ribbon	Not compatible with machine specified.
Width	Not as specified.
Length	Not as specified.
Leader signal	Missing
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing the supplier's employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Note. Purchaser shall specify the ribbon dimensions and the machine on which the ribbons are intended to be used.

When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.